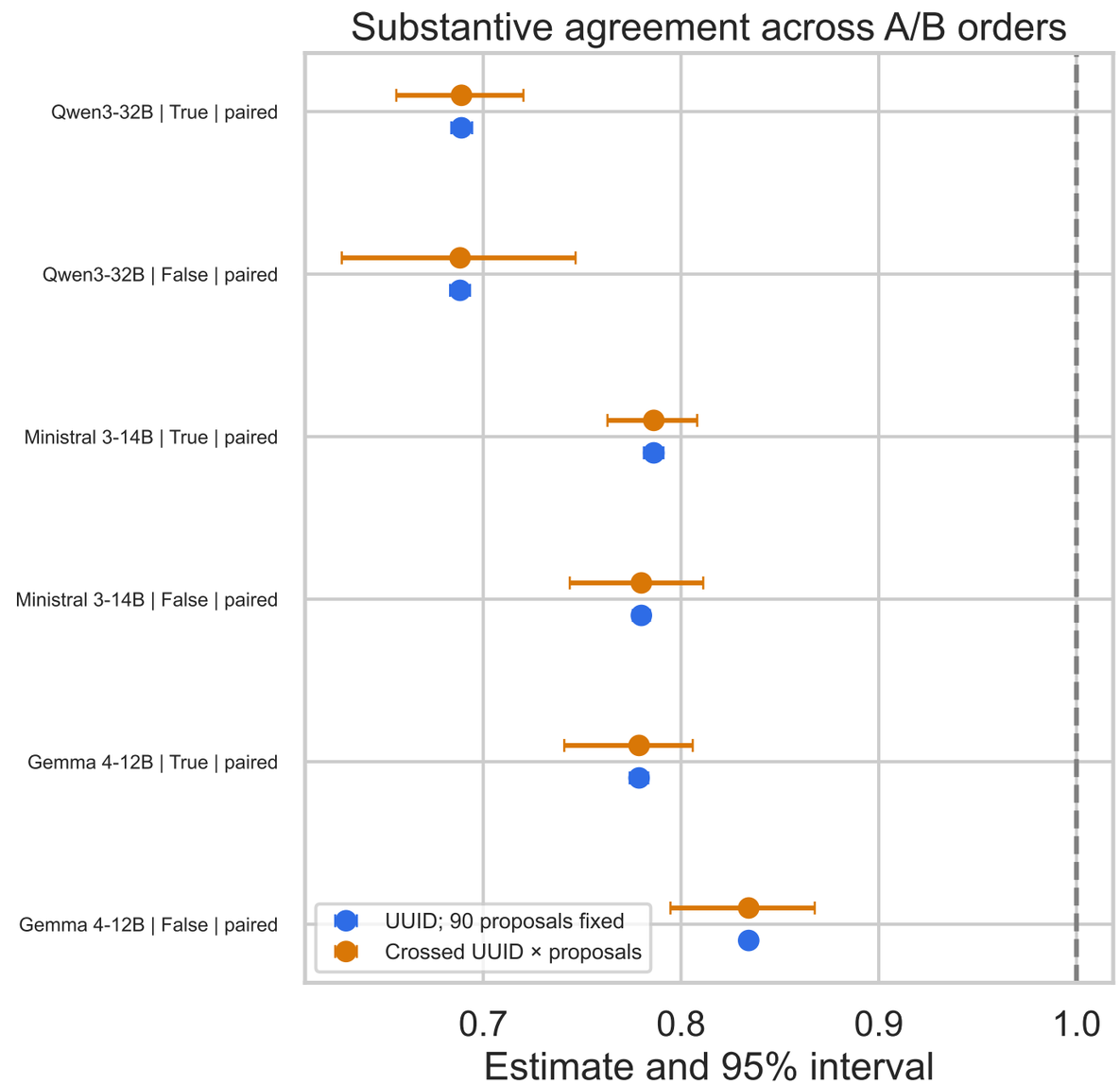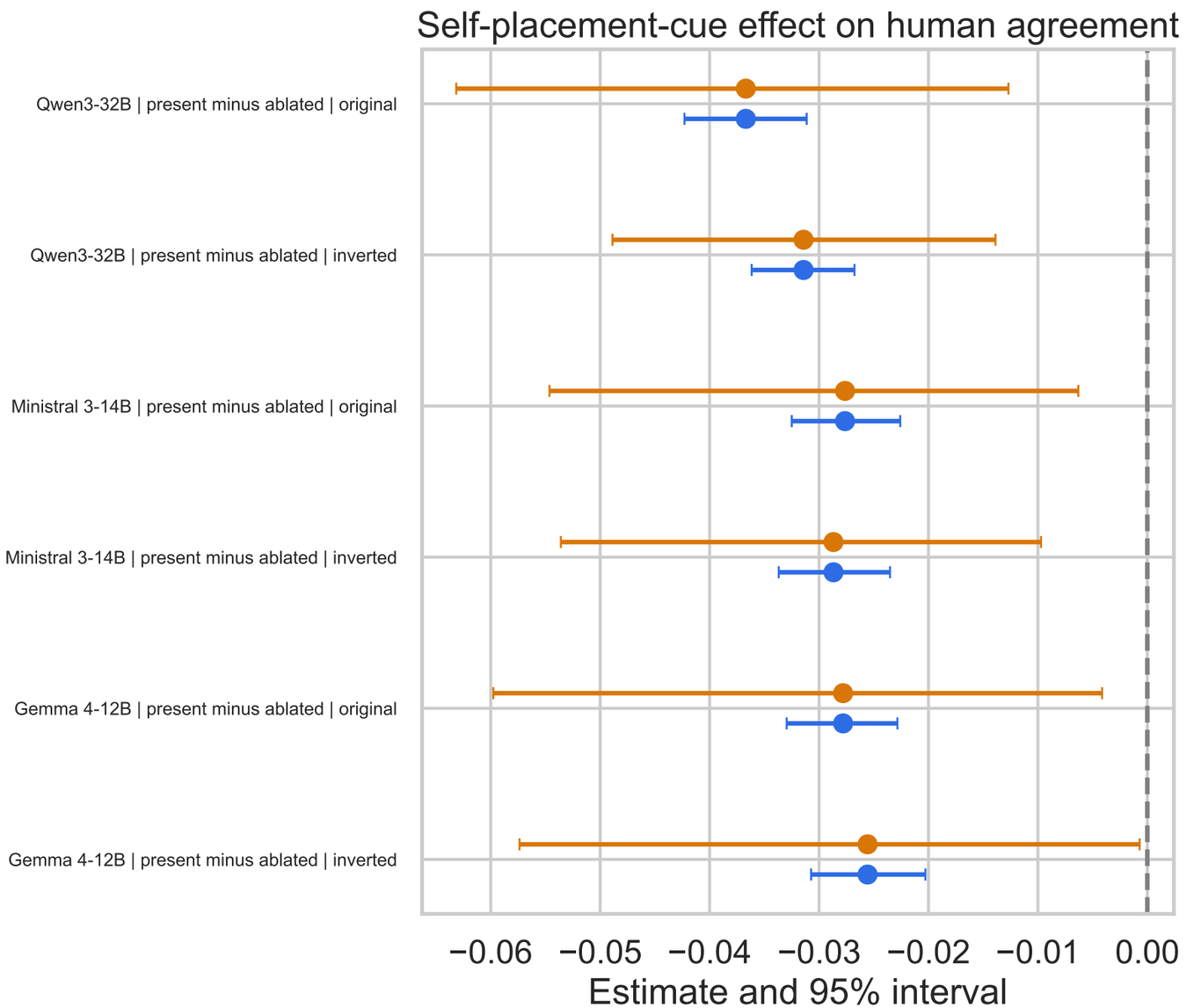Conditional inference and proposal-composition robustness